

SOC Incident Report

SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTER • INCIDENT INVESTIGATION & ESCALATION

SEVERITY: CRITICAL

INCIDENT ID CLD010	CATEGORY Phishing / HR Scam	VERDICT True Positive	STATUS Escalated to IR
ASSIGNED ANALYST Rida Abbas	REPORTED DATE 17/08/2026	ESCALATED DATE 17/08/2026	TARGET SCOPE 32 Corporate Users

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Incident Overview: On August 17, 2026, 5 users flagged a phishing email titled "Payroll update: action required before Friday payrun". SIEM log correlation expanded the attack scope to **32 targeted mailboxes** originating from malicious IP 192.0.2.10. Investigation confirmed **1 user account compromise (Priya)** following credential submission and subsequent unauthorized access from Bucharest, Romania.

32 TOTAL TARGETED	5 REPORTED EMAIL	3 CLICKED LINK	1 ACCOUNT COMPROMISED
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PHISHING EMAIL & HEADER ANALYSIS

ATTRIBUTE	OBSERVED TECHNICAL VALUE / VALIDATION
Subject Line	Payroll update: action required before Friday payrun
Sending IP	192.0.2.10 (Flagged in Threat Intel for phishing & spam)
Attacker Domain	cloudora-hr-portal.example
Return-Path / Reply-To	bounce@cloudora-hr-portal.example / hr-support@cloudora-hr-portal.example
Authentication Status	SPF: FAILED DKIM: None DMARC: None
Phishing URL	http://cloudora-hr-portal.example/payroll/confirm?empid=EMP1042&token=7f3ac9

IMPACT ANALYSIS: COMPROMISED ACCOUNT

Target User: Priya (Finance / Payroll)

ACCOUNT COMPROMISED

- 07:12 UTC:** Legitimate login logged from London, UK (203.0.113.11 - Corporate IP range) on Windows 11.
- 08:20 UTC:** User clicked phishing link and **submitted credentials** on the fake payroll page.
- 08:26 UTC: Impossible Travel Alert:** Successful sign-in to Microsoft 365 from Bucharest, Romania (192.0.2.77) using Windows 10.
- 08:40 UTC:** Threat actor successfully established active Exchange Online session from Bucharest (192.0.2.77). MFA was not enforced/bypassed via captured active refresh tokens.

IMPACT ANALYSIS: CLEARED ACCOUNTS

Target User: James

CLEARED / BENIGN

- **06:40 UTC:** Signed in from UK office network (macOS, IP: 203.0.113.15).
- **09:38 UTC:** Clicked phishing URL from UK office network (IP: 203.0.113.17).
- **Post-09:38 UTC:** Active in London, UK on Windows 11 (IP: 203.0.113.22).
- **Investigation Note:** All activity originated from the internal corporate network IP range (203.0.113.x). Workstation shift from macOS to Windows 11 reflects standard multi-device usage on office Wi-Fi. No credential submission detected.

Target User: Mark Douglas

CLEARED / LINK CLICK ONLY

- **08:52 UTC:** Clicked the phishing URL from local workstation.
- **Post-08:52 UTC:** Comprehensive log check confirmed user exited without entering credentials. No subsequent external sign-ins or anomalous M365 activity observed.

INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IOCS)

IOC TYPE	VALUE / INDICATOR	CONTEXT / THREAT DESCRIPTION
Sending IP	192.0.2.10	Originating IP address transmitting phishing email to 32 mailboxes.
Attacker Sign-in IP	192.0.2.77	Malicious IP used for unauthorized sign-in to Priya's account from Bucharest.
Attacker Domain	cloudora-hr-portal.example	Spoofed domain hosting credential harvesting infrastructure.
Mail Relay Host	mail-relay-out.cloudora-hr-portal.example	Outbound relay server host used by attacker domain.
Return-Path	bounce@cloudora-hr-portal.example	Envelope-from bounce handling address.
Reply-To Address	hr-support@cloudora-hr-portal.example	Harvesting inbox address designated in email header.
Phishing Link	http://cloudora-hr-portal.example/payroll/...	Credential harvesting landing page targeting payroll tokens.

MITRE ATT&CK MAPPING

ATTACK PHASE	MITRE ID	TECHNIQUE NAME	DETAILS IN YOUR INVESTIGATION
Phishing Email	T1566.002	Spearphishing Link	Phishing email containing fake payroll link sent to 32 users.
Compromised Account	T1078.004	Valid Accounts: Cloud Accounts	Attacker logged into M365 / Exchange Online using Priya's stolen credentials.
Impossible Travel	T1535	Unused/Unusual Location	Sign-in flagged from Bucharest, Romania, 6 minutes after activity in London, UK.

CONTAINMENT & ACTION PLAN

- **Account Security (Priya):** Reset password for Priya for Microsoft Office 365 and perform credential reset. Block all active refresh token sessions to terminate unauthorized access immediately.
- **Multi-Factor Authentication:** Set up MFA for Priya's account to secure future sign-ins.
- **Mailbox & Forwarding Review:** Review Priya's Exchange Online mailbox rules and forwarding settings to ensure no unauthorized forwarding or features exist.